

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 30, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Nahum 3:12-19

12 All your strongholds are fig trees with ripened figs: If they are shaken, They fall into the mouth of the eater.

13 Surely, your people in your midst are women! The gates of your land are wide open for your enemies; Fire shall devour the bars of your gates.

14 Draw your water for the siege! Fortify your strongholds! Go into the clay and tread the mortar! Make strong the brick kiln!

15 There the fire will devour you, The sword will cut you off; It will eat you up like a locust. Make yourself many—like the locust! Make yourself many—like the swarming locusts!

16 You have multiplied your merchants more than the stars of heaven. The locust plunders and flies away.

17 Your commanders are like swarming locusts, And your generals like great grasshoppers, Which camp in the hedges on a cold day; When the sun rises they flee away, And the place where they are is not known.

18 Your shepherds slumber, O king of Assyria; Your nobles rest in the dust. Your people are scattered on the mountains, And no one gathers them.

19 Your injury has no healing, Your wound is severe. All who hear news of you Will clap their hands over you, For upon whom has not your wickedness passed continually?

II. Key Summary

- The prophet compares Assyria's strongholds to ripe figs that fall with a single shake, showing they have no real defense against God's judgment (v. 12)
- Assyria's vast merchants and commanders are like locusts — overwhelming in number but scattered in an instant when the pressure hits (vv. 16-17)
- Nahum declares Assyria's wound is beyond healing, and all the nations they had

oppressed clap their hands at the news of their fall (vv. 18-19)

III. Passage Analysis

The Things We Count On Can Crumble Faster Than We Think

"We often have our strongholds of sin and pride that we put great confidence in, but they are ready to be shaken and fall to the ground." [1]

Assyria's fortresses looked unbreakable from the outside, but Nahum compared them to overripe figs — one shake and they're gone. Whatever we build our confidence in — strength in numbers, influence, or reputation — can collapse just as quickly when it faces something greater than itself.

God's Justice Is the Answer the Oppressed Have Been Waiting For

"God grieves over death, but his goodness and justice compel him to orchestrate the downfall of oppressive, destructive nations." [2]

Verse 19 says that all who hear the news of Nineveh's fall will clap their hands — not out of cruelty, but relief. For generations, nations had suffered under Assyrian brutality. Their response is the exhale of people who finally see justice done. Nahum shows us that God is not a passive observer when evil thrives; his justice simply operates on a timeline we cannot always see.

IV. Reflection Question

Is there something you rely on to feel safe — grades, a friend group, your reputation, or your skills?

Nahum says Assyria's strongholds fell "into the mouth of the eater" with one shake. The things we trust most can be more fragile than they look — and God invites us to ask what our security is actually built on.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/nahum-3/>

[2] BibleProject, Book of Nahum Guide, <https://bibleproject.com/guides/book-of-nahum/>